

Module 3 — Chain of Control

Category: Governance & Enforcement

Subcategory: Identity

Module: Chain of Control

Type: Identity Module

Standard: OBIDENTITY™ — Origin-Bound Identity Standard

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Protection: MIP™ — Methodological Intellectual Property

Canonical Language: English (UCL™)

Canonical Definition

Chain of Control defines the structural conditions under which control, authority, and responsibility over an identity remain continuous, traceable, and non-transferable without record.

Integrity exists only when every action affecting identity can be linked to a responsible actor within a continuous chain of control.

Why This Matters

An identity without defined control cannot be governed.

Without a chain of control:

- identity actions may have no accountable actor
- authority may be transferred without trace
- responsibility may become fragmented
- identity may be manipulated without detection

This creates systems where identity exists, but responsibility does not.

Chain of Control ensures that identity is always linked to accountable authority.

Minimum Implementation Framework (MIF)

Step 1 — Define Control Authority

Identity must have a defined controlling authority.

Minimum requirement:

- identifiable controlling entity
 - defined authority scope
 - clear ownership or control reference
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Step 2 — Trace All Control Actions

All actions affecting identity must be traceable.

Minimum requirement:

- identifiable actor for each action
 - recorded control events
 - time-linked action history
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Step 3 — Preserve Control Continuity

Control must remain continuous across time.

Minimum requirement:

- no gaps in control chain
 - no undefined transitions
 - no anonymous authority changes
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Step 4 — Prevent Untraceable Transfer

Control must not be transferred without record.

Minimum requirement:

- traceable control transfer
 - no hidden delegation
 - no loss of accountability
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Use Case 1 — Identity Ownership and Transfer

Scenario

An identity is transferred between individuals, organizations, or systems.

Application

Chain of Control ensures that each transfer is recorded and traceable, preserving responsibility.

Result

- clear ownership history
 - traceable authority transitions
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- no loss of accountability
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Use Case 2 — AI Agent Control and Governance

Scenario

An AI agent operates under changing control, such as different operators or governing entities.

Application

Chain of Control ensures that all control actions and authority changes are recorded and linked to responsible actors.

Result

- traceable governance of AI identity
 - clear accountability for actions
 - reduced risk of uncontrolled identity manipulation
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Structural Principle

Control without traceability is not control.
Responsibility without continuity does not exist.

Closing Statement

An identity without accountable control is not governable.

Related Documents

→ [OBIDENITY™ Standard](#)

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Canonical Source

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